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ROCKWOOL A/S (ROCK.B.DK)

Analyst Meeting - ESG

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MANAGEMENT DISCUSSION SECTION

Kim Junge Andersen

Chief Financial Officer & Senior Vice President, ROCKWOOL A/S

Hello to everyone and welcome to the Conference Call on ESG topics and the ROCKWOOL Sustainability Report 2023. My name is Kim Andersen. I'm the CFO of ROCKWOOL A/S. Today, I'm pleased to present CEO, Jes Hansen; and SVP, Group Marketing, Communications and Public Affairs, Mirella Vitale.

For the first part of this call, all participants will be in a listening-only mode. As a reminder, this conference call is being recorded. First, we will go through our presentation of today's ESG topics, the ROCKWOOL Sustainability Report 2023. Afterwards, we will be ready to answer all your questions. Mirella, I now hand over the word to you.

Mirella Vitale

SVP-Group Marketing & Communications, ROCKWOOL A/S

Okay. Thank you, Kim. If we go to slide 2, the agenda, so we have a lot to go through this afternoon. So we will talk briefly about our progress on our sustainability goals, spend a little bit more time talking about our decarbonization plans and our trajectory towards the 2050 goals. Then we'll look at our performance in the ESG rating schemes and how we're getting ready for the new reporting requirements. And then we'll take some time to review EU policies and how these are potential sustainable business drivers for ROCKWOOL.

So if we go to slide 3 where you can see our sustainability goals, as you would have seen already in the financial announcement that Kim and Jes has presented, we're progressing very well in all areas and have, in fact, exceeded all our intermediate 2022 goals. Our primary focus is on the short to immediate term and on achieving our 2034 goals. But of course, this is a means and a stepping stone for us to reach our long-term 2050 goals.

If we go to slide 4, we have, for many years, supported Europe's transformation to a climate-neutral, competitive and sustainable economy by 2050. But we wanted to have a clearly defined pathway to achieving those goals according to a final and defined definition of net zero. This has now fallen into place, both in the EU and with the science-based targets. So it was a natural step for us in 2023 to make that commitment towards net zero for our greenhouse gas emissions in Scope 1, 2 and 3 by 2050.

If we go to the next slide and one more, slide 6. In ROCKWOOL's case, reaching our 2050 goals, electrifying our melting process is where we will have the greatest impact. Compared to the 2019 baseline where we started from, we reduced our absolute greenhouse gas Scope 1 and 2 emissions by 4%, and our Scope 3 emissions by 1%. Due to the nature of our business, however, it is important for us to underline that our decarbonization trajectory towards our 2050 ambition will not be linear, just as it will not be linear to 2034. There will be ups and

downs in our progress. However, thanks to our continued focus on conversions to low carbon melting technology and the commissioning of factories based on electrical melting, we will have significant positive impacts on carbon emissions to report over the next few years.

Our newly opened facility in China, for example, started operations using electric melting technology and we expect will reduce annual CO2 emissions by more than 60% compared to the decommissioned factory it replaces. Furthermore, our manufacturing facility in Mississippi successfully transitioned to natural gas. So today both our US factories are running on natural gas.

If we go to slide 6. As I mentioned, electrifying our melting process is what drives the biggest impact in our decarbonization and is the main lever to achieving our targets to 2050. We're deploying our technology both in existing factories and in new build factories. In addition to Norway, where we reduced our CO2 emissions by 70%. We're currently in the process of electrifying France, Germany, Netherlands, Romania and Switzerland. Where electric melting is not an option due to inadequate supply of low-carbon electricity, we've developed a unique fuel flexible melting technology, so that we can use biogas or natural gas in addition to coal. This technology is already being used in our factories in Denmark, for example, where this fuel technology was actually developed.

If we go to slide 7, I think it must be understood – sorry, slide 8. Slide 8. That electrifying our existing and building new electricity factories is not as straightforward as it would seem. There are many external factors that influence our decisions, not only on how but when and where to convert or to build. In fact, in any given location where we are considering to convert an existing or build a new factory, we have to ensure, first of all, that the grid can actually handle a large facility like ours, that the transmission lines that we need are in place in order to get the low carbon electricity to our location. And obviously, we also have to look at the cost and how long it takes to get the grid connected.

I would say and this is not only for our industry but for heavy and energy-intensive industries in general, that getting connected to the electrical grid is probably the most underestimated challenge towards electrification goals right now in the business. It should also be underlined that off-the-shelf, large-scale electrical melting technologies doesn't exist today, so what we are using in ROCKWOOL is, of course, proprietary technology.

Then we can move to slide 9, where I'm happy to say that yesterday, we actually announced the purchase of 100 hectares of land in Walla Walla County, Washington State, where the intention is to build a state-of -the-art manufacturing facility, again featuring a proprietary electrical melting technology. Right now, we have not confirmed any timeline for the new facility, but this would be ROCKWOOL's fifth North American manufacturing facility and would support our growing demand and expansion plans for the company's products in Western United States.

Slide 10. In 2020, we increased our ambition by committing to science-based targets with two additional goals to reduce absolute greenhouse gas emissions. These two goals, approved and verified by SBTi, are to reduce absolute Scope 1 and 2 greenhouse gas emissions by 38%, and absolute Scope 3 greenhouse gas emissions by 20%. Both by 2034, with a baseline of 2019. These goals are in line with the SBTi well below 2-degree scenarios, and we continue to focus and prioritize these goals. At this time, we're unable to commit to a linear year-on-year reduction trajectory to 1.5 degrees, but that does not change our long-term commitment and our ambition to reach those 2050 goals. So again, for the – due to the nature of our industry, our trajectory cannot be calculated so easily year-on-year, but the end goal remains unaltered.

If we go then into our next section where we'd like to talk a little bit about rating schemes and the new reporting requirements, we jump to slide 12. Obviously, the most – there's a substantial amount of new reporting

requirements falling into place in the EU for EU-headquartered companies. And the most significant and probably the most important one is the CSRD. So, it will require a lot of new reporting and data collection. But it will also, we hope, help provide a more level playing field when it comes to actually the ESG ratings.

So if we jump directly to slide 14, let's look at how we're actually performing in the ESG rating schemes. At present, we're rated by four different schemes: the Carbon Disclosure Project, where ROCKWOOL ranks as an A-. This is the second-highest level with regards to climate change disclosure. If you compare us to our competitors or industry peers, we actually compare on par.

Carbon disclosure is, of course, primarily focused on air emissions. But they are now introducing a new segment to require disclosure on water, which we are currently evaluating, and we hope to disclose further on that in the coming months.

We're also ranked by MSCI, Morgan Stanley Capital International. ROCKWOOL ranks as a AA leader against, again, the 104 companies within the building industry that are evaluated by them. ROCKWOOL is on par with most of our key competitors.

We're also ranked by Sustainalytics, where we're assessed as having a medium ESG risk. Here, we actually rank slightly below our competitors. Again, the ESG ratings value and weigh different things, and here, I think the focus is a little bit higher on the S, where ROCKWOOL compares slightly lower compared to some of our key competitors; whereas if you look at ISS ESG rankings, ROCKWOOL ranks a B with a prime status. And when you look into the details of this ranking, we actually rank ahead of our primary competitors in this rating scheme.

So I think we can – we really understand the value of the rating schemes. We disclose. But everyone can probably agree that there's a – there's very different methodologies and understanding very different methodologies in understanding and waiting systems behind each of these rating schemes.

So this leads me to my next slide where, as I said, there's a – there are many ESG ratings and other sustainability ranking schemes or platforms in the market, but it is important to recognize that it's not a precise science. Nothing is harmonized right now and in some cases companies have the flexibility to just decide what to disclose. And that is why you see some companies ranking very high on one scheme and significantly lower in others. Not only are the methodologies evolving within the scheme, but from one year to the other, which is of course fine. But it does require an extra effort for us to sort of add to the new methodology, reassess what we are doing, and be able to present new data to each of these schemes.

So far we see that European Parliament and the European Council are looking at creating a scheme and have already signed a provisional agreement to guarantee transparency and integrity of environmental, social and governance rating schemes. And again, we're looking forward to a more harmonized approach across the European Union.

Then if we jump into the reporting. Governance and preparation for CSRD. Of course, as I said, there is substantial new reporting requirements falling into place. The aim of the EU CSRD is to drive positive change, which of course we welcome by ensuring that companies disclose information about the impacts of their activities on people in the environment. And here you will not be able to select what you disclose but there will be some mandatory disclosures. Rockwool has been working towards the reporting deadlines, and we feel very well prepared to be able to adhere to what we need to for the next reporting year.

If we go to the next slide where we look briefly at the CSRD. The reporting requirements begin CSID. The reporting requirements begin for this year, for the reporting of our next reporting. There are lists of several specific parameters and topics on which we will have to report. Some of these are new and some we are already reporting on them. And again, also, it's clear to be understood that what we have today in the CSID is industry-agnostic. So there's no specific reporting for a given industry. We all report on the same parameters, but we do expect the new sector-specific reporting systems to be in place by 2026.

And in the sector-specific, I should also mention that ROCKWOOL is going to fall into the same category as glass and ceramics. So not in the same category as steel and cement and some of the other heavy industries.

If we go to the next slide where we look at double materiality, an assessment was carried out in ROCKWOOL between June and September, 2023 in preparation for the European Sustainability Reporting Standards. More than 50 sustainability topics were assessed and reviewed both by ROCKWOOL and our external auditor, meaning that the impacts, as well as the risks and opportunities were scored from both an impact materiality perspective and a financial materiality perspective.

The DMA will structure our 2024 Sustainability Report, and that will be combined with our financial statements next year. So we will issue one report, and we will reference to 15 primary sustainability topics and what this means in practice that, we'll be moving from 25 indicators that are now audited externally to 85 indicators.

Then, we touch upon EU taxonomy. It's a a core part of the EU sustainable finance strategy. It's a regulation that provides the first uniform and credible standard and a common language that allows economic parties to align their activities with the transition to low carbon and sustainable pathways. And of course, we continue towards that trajectory. We understand that sustainable finance and ESG reporting are fundamental for the EU Green Deal approach. And again, the ambition of all these policies is to create that level playing field and increase transparency across businesses and across their value chain. Still, there are some gray areas to be defined, but we continue to align our activities and our customer offering to the sustainable finance taxonomy. We're very pleased that the addition of circularity requirements for building construction and renovation are coming into play because we really believe this can support the growth of secondary materials market that will enable us to boost our circularity objectives.

Social and human rights, if we go to the next slide. We are, we reconfirmed and are committed to human rights across all the key international standards, Universal Declaration of Human Rights, International Labor Organization conventions, United Nations Guiding Principles. And we have a very solid structure in place in place. We have a human rights committee where both Kim and myself represent the group management, together with our Head of HR and other members of management across our business units. We have a process in place and procedures where we are continuously auditing and looking at new ways to improve further, and we are also establishing training and awareness initiatives across the group to ensure that all our policies are upheld.

Then, we go to sort of the final segment of this presentation where we're looking at the sustainable business drivers from a regulatory and policy perspective. So if we move to the next slide. Obviously, ROCKWOOL doesn't operate in a vacuum. So that was the reason we wanted to touch on how policy and regulatory framework shapes our sustainability agenda and our impact in the market. It's important to say that the EU climate and energy policy broadly supports our decarbonization strategy, and we don't expect that to change despite the fact of voices of some growing opposition within the EU.

Buildings and energy efficiency continue to be a major area of focus, both for the policymakers, which is increasing demand for ROCKWOOL solutions for residential and industrial, and then the sustainable product

policy developments at an EU level are heading in the right direction for us. But we would like to see more done in particular with regards to a circular economy aspect for the built environment specifically.

If we go to the next slide, you will see these are the current focus areas. There's a plethora of EU regulation coming into place, but this is where our current focus is because these policies are either in the final negotiation phase or in the consultation phases. There's more. This is not exhaustive, but it gives a good overview of what we're looking at today. And of course, we add one element, which is a national policy so not managed at EU level, which is a fire safety policy, but continues to be very important for ROCKWOOL and our positioning in the market.

But for the sake of today's meeting, if we go to the next slide, I have highlighted here where I'm going to zoom in and focus for this session. But of course, anybody is welcome to reach out to us and ask questions on how we're – how we expect the other policies to develop and support our business, going forward.

So we can jump to the next slide. Building renovation. We've actually had this on the agenda a few times in these sessions. We continue to say that the Energy Performance of Building Directive will drive up the renovation rates. Of course, we look forward to and are working towards the implementation in the markets.

Financial incentives and mechanisms do exist. There's the recovery and resilience facility funding, which is which is still active and still available. There's the social climate fund, which will kick in as of 2027. But we also see at a national level, sometimes even at a city level new financial schemes and mechanisms coming into place.

This proposal forms part of the EU's commission work for 5055 and it grows the insulation market as a whole. But our products are well positioned to take their fair share of the market, and in some cases potentially even more than their fair share. In particular, when we're looking at the growing need and the obligation to have PV panels placed on roofs, we believe and see an opportunity for our non-combustible materials to really move into the market and play a very big role in ensuring the safety of those buildings.

If we go to our next slide where we talk about energy efficiency. This is and always was recognized as a key element of the EU green deal and it continues to keep a high level of political support. I would say that it actually became even more important at the EU level with the REPowerEU plan, where the need to reduce dependence on the importation of fossil fuels really came into play, in particular due to the war in Russia and Ukraine.

The EU has pushed for energy efficiency not only in the EU but is actually driving this agenda globally. So for the first time we actually saw that at the COP28 there was not only a pledge on renewables, but actually a pledge on renewables and energy efficiency. As part of this pledge, a 118 countries signed the commitment to double signed the commitment to double average annual energy efficiency improvement rates from 2% to 4% until 2030. They also agreed to establish energy efficiency first as the first fuel principle at the core of their policymaking, planning and investment decisions.

Again, this is very promising. We're really happy to see that energy efficiency is traveling outside of the EU. We could already see signs in some of the US states and cities, but it's all down to implementation at the end, so working with key stakeholders within the markets to ensure that they have full implementation plans to achieve those goals.

In addition, there's the Industrial Emissions Directive, where it's actually requiring industries to focus on their resource efficiency and on circular economy. So we also see the possibility to boost stone wool as we believe when they specify best available techniques, they will focus on having noncombustible solutions in the industrial

technical installation space. Also important to underline that the policy does include a focus on addressing energy poverty, which aligns perfectly with our purpose to be able to provide affordable and safe housing to all.

We go to our next slide, fire safety. Of course, fire safety policy creates an additional demand for noncombustible insulation, whether it stone wool or other products that they put on the façade. The recent happenings in Valencia show that this is really a reality today. It does happen. There are fire risks. In fact, we know that as a result of the Valencia fire, more and more countries are looking at how many buildings they have with combustible façades and what the potential risks are and what it would take to actually remediate to these risks.

So our position on façades, on ventilated So our position on facades, on ventilated facades or on ethics continues to be the same. When you have a high rise building and a high risk building, you have the option of a non-combustible facade solution, so there's no reason to take that risk. It's either combustible or noncombustible, so the noncombustible linear option is always the one that should be preferred in these situations.

Then, we go to the circular economy action. ROCKWOOL prioritizes circularity and so, does the industry. But we can only have a fully circular approach across our entire value chain if the right incentives and policy measures are actually in place. The challenge we face right now in the EU is a lack of harmonization. It's very, very different from country to country. We need a higher level of ambition, not only in the EU, but in the member states.

But above all, I think, the other the other key factor that is holding sort of this back is that there's no clear definitions of recyclability, recycled content and other key concepts. So we need from our side, we believe we need a stronger focus on reducing the use of virgin materials in the construction products, in the first place. These problems, of course, make it more difficult for us to deliver on our circularity ambitions and to further expand our ROCK Cycle program.

Again, this is not only geographic expansion, but also expanding the uptake of ROCK Cycle within specific countries. In 2020, the Circular Economy Action Plan did promise to address construction and demolition waste, but it actually, was not delivered at that time. But now, we have a revision of the Waste Framework Directive where we do see that they are trying to address the challenges of construction and demolition waste.

Right now, construction and demolition waste accounts for one-third of all waste generated in the EU. And if the renovation rates go up as they are expected to go up, we will of course see this number increase. This means that the EU should get ahead of this issue and ensure that the Waste Framework Directive incentivizes the truly circular approach and rewards companies with higher performance on durability, recyclability and companies that have the possibility of reducing virgin material use. Again, all elements were ROCKWOOL products and offering falls nicely into place.

Finally, when we're looking at this current package of EU regulation, we have the EU rules on green claims and empowering consumers. This will require full substantiation of all sustainability claims by businesses, including documentation. ROCKWOOL products performed very well on all key sustainability criteria, including durability, recyclability, recycled content and water consumption, all to be considered key elements of the sustainability pathway to 2050. So, we embrace these new rules. We're not concerned that we're not able to provide the documentation or the substantiation that is needed. In fact, we believe that these rules should help build consumer confidence and sustainability labelling, and we believe it will actually further boost the uptake of Stonewall compared to synthetic or fuel-based alternatives.

The EU rules also increasingly focus on reducing the use of substances of concern, including flame retardants. So again, with the upcoming additional restrictions on flame retardants that we expect on this clear labelling and

use substantiation of sustainable products, we believe that Stonewall has an advantage compared to other insulation alternatives.

Also and finally, the safe and sustainable by design and essential use concepts are likely to shape the policy of – on on flame retardants and will help further position stone wool over the combustible alternatives as every product containing flame retardants will have to clearly claim that they are and will not be able to be labelled as safe and sustainable by design.

So that comes to an end of what we have to present today but we open up for Q&A.

QUESTION AND ANSWER SECTION

Operator: We will now begin the question-and-answer session. [Operator Instructions] We ask that you please limit yourself to two questions. At this time, we'll pause momentarily to assemble our roster. The first question today comes from Brijesh Siya from HSBC. Please go ahead.

Brijesh Siya

Q

Hi. Good afternoon. I have two with the first one is on the recycling. So you have expanded the recycling to, I believe, 22 [indiscernible] 00:26:56 Then why is that number down 13% year-on-year? Is that I believe [indiscernible] 00:27:05 you want and that you are expanding your capacity there even though the volume is [indiscernible] 00:27:08 kind of move up. So I just wanted to understand a little bit more about why that Y-o-Y basis that number is now almost 13% in terms of waste collection and recycling. And the second one is was on your carbon intensity. So scope on carbon intensity looks similar. It hasn't changed on a year-on-year basis. But the Scope 2 emission has gone off. Can you just explain why that is?

Mirella Vitale

SVP-Group Marketing & Communications, ROCKWOOL A/S

A

Okay. Let me see if I understood. Your first question is why our recycling content or our recycling – the recycling that we have taken back into the factories has reduced. Is that what you're asking?

Q

Yeah, it's the volume. It's the volume of the recycled content you have done.

Mirella Vitale

SVP-Group Marketing & Communications, ROCKWOOL A/S

A

Yeah. So, basically, it is availability of recycled – of those materials coming back into the factories and us being able to take in those secondary raw materials into the factory. If there's no incentive for a particular country to actually bring back the material and landfill is still the cheaper alternative, then of course that's what they'll do. I think one of the things that we're pushing in the European Union is that if a product can be recycled, then recycling that product must be made mandatory.

Today, that is not the case. Just because you have a product that can be recycled doesn't necessarily oblige the end user to recycle it. So I think that's also why we see that the volumes are decreasing because when you see

transportation costs going up, then that incentive for the construction side or the construction companies to actually bring it back to the factories of course decreases. So that's why you would see that it's been going down.

Then I think your other question...

Q

Can I just ask – sorry.

Mirella Vitale

SVP-Group Marketing & Communications, ROCKWOOL A/S

Yeah. Go ahead.

A

Q

Just asking a supplementary on it. So, in that case, your target of 30 by 2030 is – clearly hinges on regulation. Without that, is there anything in raw food side can help you kind of increase that intake?

Mirella Vitale

SVP-Group Marketing & Communications, ROCKWOOL A/S

Yeah. I mean, I think we are – in some countries where schemes are in place, we are facilitating the work for some of our customers where we're actually taking the material, we're cleaning it, making sure that it's ready to go back into the factory. We take care of the waste handling where we have the possibility to do it and where we also have the authorization to do it. Again, there's no harmonized approach, so in some countries you need a very specific area in your factory to work with waste, regardless of what type of waste it is. So, of course, we are and we're doing that in the countries where that's a possibility. But of course where we don't have factories, it becomes a little bit more complicated to actually have a system where we help the customer. But it is part of our plans to always offer it and put it on the table where you see the countries where we're offering recycling. And we are, in fact, helping the customer bring the products back and doing everything we can to ensure that the volumes are increasing.

A

Then your second question, Brijesh, I think I have to ask you to repeat, please.

Brijesh Siya

No. I was asking about why there was an increase in Scope 2 emission intensity?

Q

A

Scope 2 emission intensity. But I don't think we did, I think we had a decrease in Scope 2. Let me look at my numbers correctly here. Because I believe we decreased our – yeah. Let me have a look at the numbers.

Jes Munk Hansen

President & Chief Executive Officer, ROCKWOOL A/S

Brijesh, it's Jes. What number do you refer to?

A

A

Yeah. We reduced it by 4%.

Q

Brijesh Siya

I was referring to the – yeah, I was probably referring to the – it's in the back side of the sustainability. I was looking at location-based, the other one and the direct one, CO2 intensity Scope 2 [indiscernible] 00:31:27 index. It has moved from 52 to 67.

A

Okay. Because we reduced our absolute greenhouse gas emissions in Scope 1 and 2 by 4%. When you're talking by intensity, it's the CO2 per tonne stone wool.

Q

Yeah.

A

Yeah.

Q

Yeah.

A

So – and it's just based on our production output. So, that's why you saw with less production output, then you will see an increase in the intensity.

Q

Sorry, I didn't get that. So, you think that [audio gap] 00:31:56-00:32:01.

[Technical Difficulty] 00:32:00-00:32:01

A

Put it.

A

We need to check the number...

A

Yeah.

A

...we're just going to dial it up [ph] under 00:32:07

Q

[ph] Off-line 00:32:10.

A

We'll come back to you on that one. We'll continue to move along on the questions and then we'll come back to you on that one.

Q

Fair enough. Thank you.

Operator: [Operator Instructions] There are no further questions at this time, which concludes our question-and-answer session. I would like to turn the conference back over to management for closing remarks.

Unverified Participant

Thank you very much. And just as an invitation, you are welcome to send us questions afterwards. Also, we have a more technical team, that's why we have put this deck together. And thank you for today, for Mirella for making the presentation. And thank you, everybody for attending the session today, and we wish you a very good day and the coming good weekend.

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